

ANAND SHARMA

Architect / Senior Staff Engineer

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"I love solving hard problems to build great products."

SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Software Engineer who still believes the Unix terminal is the most elegant interface ever invented. I started in graduate school with a Silicon Graphics workstation running IRIX; more than two decades later, I still strive to bring the elegance and power of that machine into products that I build at Cisco. For the past decade, I have worked on building developer-centric experiences with a TAM of 30k Cisco engineers. My focus is making complex capabilities feel simple: opinionated CI/CD pipelines, release orchestration, and multi-agent AI systems. Simply put, I like to build things that matter!

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Invited to present at the prestigious Cisco Live 2017 and Cisco Live 2016 events on advancements in DevOps and Enterprise Class Continuous Delivery
- Led Cisco IT's first Software Developer Experience as a Thought Leader, Evangelist, and Solutions Architect
- Innovated development of Cisco's first centrally managed Continuous Delivery Platform
- Architected the first customer-facing Enterprise App Store for Cisco's Cius product
- Created the first Social Computing Platform for Cisco
- Oversaw development of the first Cisco API Management Platform, featuring a customer-facing API Console

CAREER OVERVIEW

SR. STAFF SOFTWARE ENGINEER (Enterprise DevOps-as-a-Service)

Cisco Systems 📅 2023 - Present

- Lead efforts to standardize an enterprise-scale PPM tool for Operations and Engineering, including conducting a thorough analysis of Aha!, Atlassian Jira Align, and ServiceNow.
- Drive widespread adoption of Jira Align across multiple teams following a presentation to the COO on key findings.
- Investigate solutions to modernize the stack, reduce technical debt, and offer a frictionless experience for the 25K+ Cisco employees across Engineering, Customer Support, and Operations, replacing a homegrown tool for defect lifecycle management.

STAFF SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Cisco Systems 📅 2022 - 2023

- Spearhead the definition, design, documentation, and delivery of cutting-edge software delivery (Enterprise DevOps) tools and experiences to a team of over 30K software engineers.

STRENGTHS

- 🔧 Technical Architecture
- 🧠 System Design
- 📦 Solutions Delivery & Deployment
- 🔄 Agile / Iterative Methodologies
- 💻 Software Engineering (SDLC)
- 🖥️ DevOps
- 🌐 Strategic Improvement
- 💡 Executive Communications
- 🤝 Cross-functional Collaboration

EXPERIENCE / FLUENCY

Public Cloud Technologies:

AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, Lambda)

Architecture:

Event-driven Microservices Software

Data/Event Store:

MongoDB, Postgres, Oracle, Kafka

Compute:

Containers, Kubernetes, OpenStack

Dev Tools:

Git, Jenkins, Artifactory, Spinnaker

Integration Platforms:

Mashery, Layers7, Boomi

SaaS:

Salesforce Sales Cloud, Workday

Languages:

Rust, Python, Java

- Shape enterprise-wide decision-making by presenting frequent, impactful strategic and operational updates related to services and service offerings to Senior IT Leadership.
- Provide insightful thought leadership and technical solutions while evangelizing solutions to Cisco IT customers.
- Reduced costs by launching the Cisco FCS Software Distribution solution using Dev Hub Download to support shipping FCS binaries as container images instead of paying Cloud Providers to host FCS container images.

SR. SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT, DEVOPS

Cisco Systems

📅 2019 – 2022

- Introduced first-of-its-kind Code Analytics tool to measure software delivery performance (quality, security & release metrics) for over ~17k unique software, enabling 1K+ engineers to track progress on DevSecOps metrics.
- Increased adoption of Cisco IT CI/CD practices for software delivery to 90% across the organization.
- Boosted percentage of IT applications deployed into production with unit tests from 7% to 66% and improved unit test coverage for applications by 600%.
- Led event-driven microservices architecture build using a Java SpringBoot, Kafka, Redis, and Angular UX stack.

IT ARCHITECT, DEVOPS

Cisco Systems

📅 2018 – 2019

- Drove delivery of ~50k software promotions to higher lifecycle environments by creating Code Release as a single software release orchestrator to deliver software using any deployment tool anywhere.
- Grew total raw Production Deployments number by 90% and increased median daily Production Deployments by ~300% to ~100 per day.
- Reduced software promotion times to be delivered in ~10 mins, which improved *Deployment Frequency* DORA metrics for Cisco IT.
- Led event-driven microservices architecture build using a Java SpringBoot, Kafka, Redis, Argo Workflow, and React-based UX stack.

IT ARCHITECT, DEVOPS

Cisco Systems

📅 2016 – 2018

- Led Cisco IT's first-ever Software Developer Experience Portal as a Thought Leader, Evangelist and Solutions Architect. The Software Developer Experience removes friction and contextual work for the developer allowing them to continue to focus on building software.
- Improved the *Lead Time for Changes* DORA metric by reducing self-service requests to ~5 mins, resulting in the self-service of ~22k CRUD requests across 4K+ unique Software Engineers using Code Console in 2018.
- Oversaw event-driven Microservices architecture built using Java SpringBoot, MongoDB, Redis, and React-based UX stack.

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE

IT ARCHITECT, API MANAGEMENT

Cisco Systems

IT TECHNICAL LEADER, WEB 2.0

(Customer Advocacy IT Team)

Cisco Systems

IT SOFTWARE ENGINEER (Cisco

Advanced Services IT Team)

Cisco Systems

WEB ENGINEER (Full Stack & Back

End Development)

Lucent Technologies

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science,

Software Engineering

Arizona State Univ. | Tempe, AZ

Master of Science,

Industrial Engineering

Arizona State Univ. | Tempe, AZ

AWARDS



2018 Gold Stevie Winner

Enterprise Software Release
Digitization, Secure DevOps

PROMINENT PRESENTATIONS

Panel Discussion at Cisco Live 2016

"Addressing the What's, Why's and How's in the New World of DevOps"

Presentation at Cisco Live 2017

"Enterprise Class Continuous
Delivery"

Presentation at the Cloud Identity Summit 2012 | Vail, CO

"Who Says Elephant Can't Dance?
Securely Externalizing APIs @ Cisco"
(hosted by Ping Identity)

Multiple-time Executive Briefing Center (EBC) Presenter

Key Presenter to the Cisco Venture Capital team

Top proposals for spin-off ventures
for independent businesses

IT ARCHITECT, API MANAGEMENT

Cisco Systems

📅 2014 – 2016

- Launched Cisco IT's first Continuous Delivery Platform with a mix of open-source and commercial tools, resulting in ~90% adoption of CI/CD tools and mature software engineering practices to deliver software.
- Partnered with Cisco IT Delivery Organizations to successfully deliver an enterprise-wide Continuous Delivery solution that scaled across ~100 IT Services and ~2000 IT Applications.
- Enhanced deployment of IT Apps into production with Unit Tests from <10% to 60%+ by building a homegrown solution to handle continuous delivery of Oracle software, addressing a gap in Oracle's existing offerings. This solution is currently used by 90% of Cisco teams for 100+ deployments a day.
- Delivered a series of core DevOps tools including GitHub SaaS, GitHub Enterprise, CloudBees Jenkins, Artifactory, SonarQube, Spinnaker, CloudBees CDRO.